



finding quality people

Before your Interview:

- Research the company website, including news and press releases, “about the company”, culture or values, and management profiles, specifically of the individuals you know you are meeting.
- Take at least 3 ideas that interest you in your research to the interview and be prepared to discuss them.
- Review the position description (duties and requirements) and be able to relay at least 5 reasons you are the BEST FIT for this position and the Company.
- Consider how your top 5 strengths would be used in this position and be prepared to discuss how you’ve used those strengths in your career. Be prepared to speak on your weaknesses as well.
- Incorporate these into your interview to show the interviewer that you are prepared and serious about this role.

Interview Attires:

For Everyone:

- Business professional attire
- Plan your attire the day before your interview
- Fragrances are not recommended
- Jewelry should be simple and conservative
- Clean hands, trimmed nails, and a professional hair style are a must
- Do not remove your suit jacket unless the interviewer offers

For Women:

- Tailored Suits (navy, gray, or black) should be worn with either a knee-length skirt or tailored pants
- Blouses should be pressed, basic, and modesty is recommended
- Makeup and nail polish should be minimal

For Men:

- Non-novelty ties should be worn with a navy, gray, or black suit
- Shirts should be pressed and basic
- Shoes should be shined, conservative, and of an oxford or wingtip style

What to Take:

- A folder or portfolio with multiple copies of your resume and references, along with a good pen
- The position description (when possible)
- Three to Five questions you will ask the interviewer (see examples)

What to Leave:

- Cell phones, tobacco products, and chewing gum in your car
- Other Distractions

Behavioral Tips:

- Greet your interviewer with a firm handshake and an enthusiastic, sincere smile
- Greet the interviewer by Mr. or Ms. and their last name
- Wait until you are offered a chair before taking a seat
- Sit upright, look alert and interested at all times. This includes making eye contact and nodding to let the interviewer know you are listening
- Be assertive and proud of your accomplishments but don’t be over-confident
- Show enthusiasm – If you are interested in the opportunity, let them know. If you are not interested, your responsiveness demonstrates your professionalism.
- Be confident throughout the interview, even if you sense the interview is not going well. Some interviewers may try to discourage you to test your reaction.
- Most importantly – Be Yourself!



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Avoid:

- Answering questions with a “yes” or “no” response. Explain your answers.
- Exaggerating your answers – answers should be truthful and direct
- Sharing personal stories or information about yourself or others unrelated to the position or qualifications of the position
- Making derogatory remarks about previous employers, supervisors, or co-workers. When explaining your departure, limit comments to those necessary to communicate your rationale.
- Asking questions about compensation, vacation, and other benefits on your first interview. Use your interview to gain the interviewer’s confidence that you are the BEST Fit for the position rather than misleading them into thinking you are only concerned about “What’s in it for you.” These are important issues but it’s more appropriate to discuss further in the process. If the interviewer asks about your salary requirements, indicate your earnings but emphasize your interest in the opportunity with their company.

Sample Questions you may be asked:

Rehearse your answers to these questions before the interview

- Tell me about yourself, your background, and accomplishments.
- What are your strengths? Weaknesses?
- Describe your ideal job.
- Why are you the best FIT for this position?
- How do you define success? Failure?
- Tell me about a work assignment you did not complete successfully and why.
- What motivates you most in a job?
- List your top 3 achievements.
- What do you know about our company?
- Why did you want to interview with our company?
- What are your career goals?
- Tell me about a work situation you handled poorly. What did you learn?
- What other opportunities are you considering in addition to ours?

Sample Questions YOU Ask:

A lack of questions could be mistaken as disinterest on your part by the interviewer

- What are the greatest challenges in this position?
- What might I expect during the first six months on the job?
- What would I be expected to accomplish in this role?
- What made the last person in this position successful?
- What characteristics or traits do successful people in this company share?
- What are the company’s plans for growth?
- What is the biggest challenge facing this department/company right now?
- How often is formal feedback (performance reviews) given? Informal?
- Do you have any concerns about my qualifications that I can address for you?

Closing and Following the Interview:

- If you are interested in the position, **let the interviewer know!** You can say something to the sound of “I’m very interested with your company, its products, and the people I’ve met. I know I would do an excellent job in the position we discussed.” You can also ask about “next steps” in their decision making process.
- Don’t be discouraged if no immediate commitment is made. Often the interviewer will need to communicate with others in the company or may need to interview more candidates.
- Thank the interviewer for their time and consideration.
- Ask those you met for a business card and immediately follow up with an appropriate email thanking them for their time and expressing your interest in the position.
- Within 48 hours follow-up with a brief, handwritten note thanking the interviewer for the opportunity to meet with them again and reiterate your interest in the position along with 2-3 quick points about how your qualifications relate to the position.
- Reach out to anyone you met and connect with them via LinkedIn and/or also “like” or follow their company page.